

Pathways to Teaching English as a Second Language (ESL)



Are you looking to fill a vacant ESL position in your school? You may have an educator in your school or district who is already qualified to fill the position! The requirements below outline the most common credentials that educators earn to work in an ESL setting.

Professional Educator License (PEL) Requirements

Option 1 – To teach in any of the grades PK-6:

- ✓ PEL + ESL endorsement
- ✓ PEL + ENL endorsement
- ✓ PEL + Bilingual endorsement
- ✓ PEL + ENL endorsement with a language designation

Option 2 – To teach in any of the grades 7-12:

- ✓ PEL + ESL endorsement
- ✓ PEL + ENL endorsement

Educator License with Stipulations (ELS) Requirements

Option 1 – ELS-VIT + passing score on the English Language Proficiency test

Option 2 – ELS-TBE license (valid for grades PK-6 only)

Short-Term Approval (STA) Requirements

Option 1 – STA – ESL

- ✓ PEL (in a teaching field for any grade range)
- ✓ Nine semester hours of coursework in ESL (specific coursework is required)

These approvals are temporary credentials that allow an educator to immediately begin teaching while working toward full licensure requirements.

Application procedures

View full requirements

1

Create or login to your existing ELIS account

2

Submit the applicable endorsement or approval application

3

Pay the \$50 application fee

4

Submit required forms and transcripts to your ROE/ISC

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